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TIL TA'LIMI: YANGI YONDASHUVLAR VA INNOVASIYALAR

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INCORPORATING HUMOUR INTO ENGLISH CLASSES FOR THE FIRST YEAR STUDENTS TO ENHANCE THEIR SPEAKING SKILLS

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Abstract. Students in their first year of studies may feel difficulty to enhance their speaking skills. There are different causes for that: not enough time during the lesson, affective filter and the established teacher's discipline. This article tries to answer the question of how implementing humour can help students to improve their speaking skills and increase their willingness to speak. This article also suggests some of the activities which may integrate humour such as negotiation of meaning, retelling a joke and a role play which can be used to enhance students speaking skills.

Key words: *speaking skills, willingness to speak, humour, humour techniques, negotiation of meaning, joke, role play*

ВКЛЮЧЕНИЕ ЮМОРА В ЗАНЯТИЯ ПО АНГЛИЙСКОМУ ЯЗЫКУ ДЛЯ СТУДЕНТОВ ПЕРВОГО КУРСА С ЦЕЛЮ РАЗВИТИЯ НАВЫКОВ РАЗГОВОРНОЙ РЕЧИ

Аннотация. Студенты первого года обучения могут испытывать трудности в развитии навыков устной речи. Причины могут быть разными: недостаточное количество времени на уроке, аффективный фильтр и установленная дисциплина преподавателя. Данная статья пытается ответить на вопрос, как применение юмора может помочь студентам улучшить навыки разговорной речи и повысить их желание говорить. В статье также предлагаются некоторые виды упражнений, которые могут включать юмор, такие как переговоры значения, пересказ анекдота и ролевая игра, которые могут быть использованы для улучшения навыков разговорной речи студентов.

Ключевые слова: *навыки разговорной речи, желание говорить, юмор, техники юмора, переговоры о значении, анекдот, ролевая игра*

In theory speaking is considered to be a complex skill which needs to be developed by considering the current proficiency of students, root causes of what affects their willingness to speak in the target language or how students' speaking ability can be improved. The causes of poor speaking skills maybe versatile: it may be the lack of speaking practice because of learning only grammatical knowledge and vocabulary in isolation (a number of enrollees who become first year students learn only grammatical knowledge, because their ultimate goal is to pass the entrance exam to a higher educational institution - HEI); or the lack of knowledge in pragmatics of the usage of target language patterns; it can also be students' feeling anxiety to speak which makes it difficult to overstep the language barrier. Therefore, the aim of this article is to explore the use of humour as a tool to help students to enhance their speaking skills in higher education during their first year of studies.

One should first define who are the first-year students in the local Uzbek higher educational context. The first-year students are the graduates of high schools, academic lyceums and professional vocational colleges with different hours of English classes exposure. To enter an Uzbek HEI, they take an English test as an element if the study direction requires knowledge of English. Respectively, most of the humanities related faculties (courses) (especially in philology) require the knowledge of English as a prerequisite to enter the HEI. According to the decree of the Cabinet of Ministers of Uzbekistan No. 395 of 13.05.2019 "On measures to implement the certificates of national and international assessment systems in admission to higher education institutions" an enrollee can receive maximum points during the entrance exam if he/she has internationally recognized language certificates such as International English Language Testing System (IELTS 5.5), Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL IBT 72), Cambridge Assessment English FCE language proficiency levels B2 and above [1]. One should note that not all of the enrollees provide such a certificate, therefore, they have to take an entrance test (which tests mostly grammatical competence, reading skills and knowledge of the target culture). Tokhtahodjaeva states that knowing grammar does not indicate that students' speaking and listening skills are well developed [2]. Therefore, one can assume that the foreign language proficiency of students after the admission to a HEI is not homogeneous. This in its turn creates a hurdle for a foreign language teacher to plan his/her lessons, in order to organize a smooth transition of the students with their background studies to a higher education level on the one hand, and on the other hand, he/she needs to deal with foreign language knowledge level

difference of admitted students. Particularly, for this study enhancing students' English-speaking abilities is of interest.

Currently, in pedagogy there is no exact system to implement humour in teaching in English to enhance students' speaking abilities. One of the reasons for that could be that this research area is relatively young, although, in the last decade the number of investigations in this sphere has significantly risen. Khodrami and Nia's study established that students' willingness to speak depends mostly on the discipline pattern set by the teacher [3]. Presumably, if the teacher is strict and his/her classes are going in a serious tone, students' willingness to speak may be low. In contrast, high-spirited classes positively affect students and teacher's rapport, thus, giving the students a feeling of 'safeness'. It helps students overcome the 'affective filter' and 'affective variables' (e.g. lack of confidence, lack of motivation and high anxiety level) and be more open to speak [4]. Besides, as Khan and Ali indicate that during the lesson there is not much time to practice speaking, because a teacher needs also to concentrate on enhancing students' other skills [5]. In their research they determined that students are afraid of teachers' negative comments regarding the mistakes they make when speaking. Other features of humour as a pedagogical tool were explored by other multiple researchers. Dieter, for instance, studied the effects which humour brings to the lessons in higher education level [6]. He states that using humour in classes has a favourable impact if it is appropriate, planned beforehand and not abusive. In his research students expressed the willingness to attend more to the lessons in which humour is used. Besides, students tend to memorize more if the teacher uses humour and are willing to ask more questions from the teacher (because the cheerful atmosphere which is created when humour is used in class gives the students the feeling of safety). Farhami and Abdollohi in their research emphasize the positive role of humour in the students' willingness to communicate and in enhancing their speaking skills. 60 students were chosen for their research who were divided in two groups: experimental and the control group. Experimental group studied speaking skills by the exposure to the humour techniques by planning lessons with humour elements which consisted of starting a lesson with humorous quotes (or a "thought of the day"), using humorous materials of different genres and telling jokes. However, the control group continued taking the foreign language class in the same method of delivery without any changes. As Farhamo and Abdollohi state the study confirmed their two hypotheses which related to the positive influence of teacher-initiated humour on "learners' willingness to communicate" and "developing learners' speaking ability" [7, 208, 209].

One of the essential aspects is which activities instigate students' willingness to speak. As an example, one can bring an activity of "negotiation of meaning".

During this task students are divided into groups and they are given some humorous texts. The task of students is to read the text and negotiate the meaning. The teacher can scaffold the text if necessary. He/she can ask students to read small excerpts and discuss these excerpts first. If the language used in the text is challenging, the teacher may decide to pre-teach some of the difficult words. After students discuss the texts in groups, teachers may facilitate the discussion by asking comprehension questions. Another interesting speaking task could be retelling a joke. For this purpose, depending on the level students have, the teacher can prepare some jokes beforehand. This task can be done in groups or in pairs. First students retell the jokes to each other and then if they wish they can retell the assigned joke in front of the whole group. One more activity could be a role play of a comedic situation. The teacher needs to find funny short plays and assign the roles (if students wish, they can choose the roles themselves). The students learn by heart their replicas and present the roles. Short plays may be in a dialogue form or it may involve more people. Of course, it is difficult to expect a very effective acting from students, however here the point is by this activity it is intended to increase students' willingness to speak and to lower the anxiety filter.

In conclusion, one may state that humour if implemented correctly and in an appropriate measure, creates a light atmosphere in the class. This helps students to overcome their affective filter and increase their willingness to communicate and speak. Some activities which may be used to enhance students' speaking abilities are negotiation of meaning, retelling a joke and doing a role play activity.

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**РАЗРАБОТКА ЗАНЯТИЯ С ПРИМЕНЕНИЕМ ТЕХНОЛОГИИ
РАЗВИТИЯ КРИТИЧЕСКОГО МЫШЛЕНИЯ НА ТЕМУ:
«ОККАЗИОНАЛИЗМЫ» (НА МАТЕРИАЛЕ ТВОРЧЕСТВА
М.ЦВЕТАЕВОЙ)**

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Аннотация. В статье предложена разработка практического занятия с применением методов и приемов технологии развития критического мышления. На примере данной технологии можно наглядно проследить эффективность применения в процессе занятия современных приемов и методов.

Ключевые слова: *технология развития критического мышления, метод, прием, преподаватель, студент.*

**DEVELOPMENT OF A LESSON USING THE TECHNOLOGY OF
DEVELOPMENT OF CRITICAL THINKING ON THE TOPIC:
"OCCASIONALISMS" (BY THE MATERIAL OF M.TSVETAYEVA'S
CREATIVITY)**

Abstract. The article proposes the development of a practical lesson using methods and techniques of critical thinking development technology. Using the example of this technology, it is possible to visually trace the effectiveness of the use of modern techniques and methods in the course of the lesson.

Keywords: *technology of critical thinking development, method, reception, teacher, student.*

Для эффективного проведения занятий преподаватель должен в образовательном процессе использовать современные технологии, методы и приемы. К одним из таких технологий относится ТРКМ, методы и приемы которой активно и продуктивно используются преподавателями на разных этапах занятия.

Методы и приемы технологии развития критического мышления состоят в развитии мыслительных навыков, которые необходимы не только в

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